FRANMARINE UNDERWATER SERVICES PTY LTD

SPUD LEG OPERATIONS

Procedure

MV ROHANI | UVI: 457394 | Class 2C

Marine Order 504 (2024) — Schedule 1 Compliance

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Approval

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Review Frequency

This document shall be reviewed at least every 12 months, or sooner following a significant incident, change of operations, vessel modification, or change in applicable legislation.

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1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This procedure establishes the requirements for the safe deployment, use, and retrieval of the spud legs on MV Rohani.

1.1 Equipment

MV Rohani is fitted with two spud legs:

(a) Starboard forward — penetrates through a hull guide. Secured with a pin that passes through the spud leg and sits on top of the hull guide.

(b) Port aft — affixed externally to the transom via a guide bracket. Secured with a pin in the same manner.

Both spud legs are deployed and retrieved manually using the deck crane (Unic UB-V504J). The crane procedure (FUS-SMS-ROH-05I) must be followed for all crane operations associated with spud leg handling.

2. PRE-DEPLOYMENT CHECKS

(a) Confirm the water depth at the deployment location is suitable for the spud leg length.

(b) Inspect both spud legs and their hull guides for damage, corrosion, or deformation.

(c) Inspect the securing pins for condition — pins must not be bent, cracked, or excessively worn.

(d) Confirm the seabed is suitable (firm substrate, not rock that could damage the spud tip or prevent penetration).

(e) Complete the crane pre-start checks per FUS-SMS-ROH-05I before using the crane to handle spud legs.

(f) Establish a clear deck area around the spud leg guide. No personnel shall stand beneath or in the swing path of a spud leg being lifted.

3. DEPLOYMENT PROCEDURE

(a) Position the vessel at the work site using the engines. The master shall confirm the vessel is in the correct location before deploying spuds.

(b) Remove the securing pin from the spud leg to be deployed.

(c) Attach the crane hook to the spud leg lifting point.

(d) Lift the spud leg clear of the hull guide (starboard forward) or bracket (port aft) using the crane.

(e) Lower the spud leg through the guide/bracket until it contacts the seabed.

(f) Continue lowering until the spud leg is firmly seated on the seabed and the vessel is held in position.

(g) Insert the securing pin through the spud leg at the hull guide/bracket to lock the spud at the correct height.

(h) Disconnect the crane hook from the spud leg.

(i) Repeat for the second spud leg if required.

(j) Once both spuds are deployed and pinned, confirm the vessel is stable and stationary before commencing work.

4. RETRIEVAL PROCEDURE

(a) Attach the crane hook to the spud leg lifting point.

(b) Take up the load on the crane to support the spud leg weight.

(c) Remove the securing pin.

(d) Lift the spud leg clear of the seabed using the crane.

(e) Raise the spud leg through the guide/bracket until it is fully retracted.

(f) Insert the securing pin to lock the spud in the stowed (raised) position.

(g) Disconnect the crane hook.

(h) Repeat for the second spud leg.

(i) Confirm both spud legs are fully retracted and pinned before the vessel transits. For transits in sheltered waters (inside port/harbour limits), spud legs may remain installed in their guides in the raised and pinned position.

5. SAFETY REQUIREMENTS

(a) The vessel may transit with spud legs installed (raised and pinned in the stowed position) in sheltered waters only — inside port and harbour limits. The vessel must not transit with spud legs lowered into the water. For open water transits outside port/harbour limits, spud legs must be removed from their guides and stowed on deck.

(b) When transiting with spud legs installed, the master must know the total vessel height including spud legs in the raised position and plan the transit route to ensure adequate clearance under all bridges, overhead cables, and other height-restricted structures along the route. Refer to FUS-SMS-ROH-05K Passage Planning.
(c) Before any transit with spud legs installed, the master shall consult nautical charts and local port information to confirm the height of all overhead obstructions on the planned route and verify clearance at the expected tidal state.
(d) Personnel must not place hands or fingers near the hull guide/bracket while a spud leg is being raised or lowered.

(e) If a spud leg becomes jammed (e.g. in rock or hard substrate), do not force retrieval. Attempt to free the spud by gently repositioning the vessel using engines. If unsuccessful, contact the East Coast Operations Superintendent for guidance.

(f) Monitor the vessel's position and stability while on spuds. If conditions deteriorate (tide change, weather, current), retrieve spuds and reposition or return to port.

(g) The crane operator must maintain visual contact with the spud leg and the deck crew during deployment and retrieval.

6. REFERENCES

FUS-SMS-ROH-05I Crane Operations

FUS-SMS-ROH-05A Pre-Departure Checks

Approved Stability Book